

Fifth Sunday After Pentecost

Dominica Quinta Post Pentecosten

TLM propers: reconciliation before sacrifice

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Fathers and saints	Connection
Introit	<i>Exaudi, Domine, vocem meam</i> (Ps. 26)	Seeking the saving God	St. Augustine on Psalm 26; St. Anselm on desire for God	The entrance cry is personal and urgent: prayer seeks the face that makes peace possible.
Collect	Love God in all things and above all things	Ordered charity	St. Augustine, <i>De doctrina christiana</i> I; St. Bernard, <i>On Loving God</i>	The collect gives the key: all reconciliation depends on loving God above every injury.
Epistle	1 Pet. 3:8-15	Unity, compassion, blessing, peace	St. Cyprian on unity; St. John Climacus on meekness	Peter turns holiness into a social form: bless, seek peace, sanctify Christ in the heart.
Gospel	Matt. 5:20-24	Leave the gift; be reconciled	St. John Chrysostom on Matthew; St. Jerome on the Sermon on the Mount	Sacrifice cannot bypass charity. The altar itself sends the worshipper toward the offended brother.
Offertory	<i>Benedicam Dominum... providebam Deum</i> (Ps. 15)	God before the eyes	St. Ignatius of Antioch on unity around the altar	Offering becomes true when the heart stands before God without cherished resentment.
Communion	<i>Unam petii a Domino</i> (Ps. 26)	Dwelling in the house of the Lord	St. Augustine on the one desire	The one thing sought purifies many divided passions.
Postcommunion	<i>Quos caelesti, Domine, dono satiasti</i>	Hidden cleansing and protection	St. Gregory on hidden sin; Desert Fathers on watchfulness	Those fed by the heavenly gift ask to be cleansed from hidden faults and freed from enemy snares.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
Literal	Matthew 5 commands reconciliation before offering the gift at the altar; 1 Peter commands unity, compassion, blessing, and the pursuit of peace.
Allegorical	The altar points to Christ's sacrifice and the Church's Eucharistic offering, where fractured charity contradicts the sacrament of unity.
Moral	The worshipper must leave resentment, contempt, and evasive delay, then seek peace in the concrete form appropriate to the offense.
Anagogical	Reconciliation before the altar prepares the soul for the peace of the heavenly temple, where no hatred can enter the vision of God.

Core Scriptural Symbols

Thread	Synthesis
Altar	The altar is the place of offering, judgment, and communion with God. In Matthew it becomes startlingly active: the altar sends the worshipper away to seek reconciliation. Patristic exegesis sees here the seriousness of charity. The symbol teaches that worship is not an escape from moral truth; the nearer the gift comes to God, the more false peace and hidden contempt are exposed.
Gift	The gift represents sacrifice, prayer, and the self being offered. Christ does not say the gift is worthless; he says it must wait. This symbol reveals that worship can be incomplete, not because ritual is empty, but because the worshipper is divided. The Church teaches that the heart offered with the gift must be reconciled as far as truth and charity permit.
Brother	The brother is not an interruption of religion but the test of it. Scripture repeatedly binds love of God to love of neighbor, and 1 Peter gives the social grammar: unity, compassion, blessing, peace. The symbol refuses abstraction. The offended brother gives the homily concrete weight, forcing anger and contempt out of the realm of private feeling and into the light of the altar.
Tongue	Peter's command to refrain the tongue from evil joins the Gospel's warnings against <i>raca</i> and <i>fatue</i> . The tongue is the bodily instrument by which contempt becomes public and durable. Patristic asceticism treats speech as a primary battlefield. The symbol shows why reconciliation must include words: blessing must replace the speech by which anger builds its case.
House of the Lord	The Communion's one desire, dwelling in the Lord's house, gathers scattered passions into a single end. The symbol contrasts the many rooms of grievance with the one house of peace. To desire God's house is to desire a communion into which hatred cannot enter. The Postcommunion then asks cleansing from hidden faults because even reconciled worshippers need interior purification.

Patristic Exegesis of the Grouped Propers

The Church groups prayer, fear of God, patience under injury, bridled speech, and reconciliation before the altar to teach that worship must become peace. Patristic exegesis of Matthew's altar command is severe: the gift is not rejected because sacrifice is unimportant, but because sacrifice is too holy to be joined to contempt. Peter's Epistle supplies the interior form of the reconciled worshipper: one who blesses, refrains his tongue from evil, and seeks peace.

Thread	Synthesis
Introit: God hears the afflicted	Patristic psalm reading hears the righteous sufferer calling on God rather than retaliating. This prepares the Epistle's command to bless instead of returning evil.
Collect: love and fear	The Collect asks that reverence and charity order the soul. The faithful need fear because anger excuses itself, and love because reconciliation cannot be reduced to etiquette.
Epistle: 1 Peter 3	Augustine and Bede read the tongue as a battlefield of charity. The one who desires life must bless, seek peace, and turn from evil speech.
Gospel: Matthew 5	Chrysostom reads the command to leave the gift as proof that God values charity over ritual display. Reconciliation with the brother is not optional preparation; it belongs to truthful sacrifice.
Offertory: the Lord before the eyes	The Offertory fixes the gaze on God, displacing the self-justifying gaze that feeds anger. The worshipper offers a heart being reordered toward peace.
Communion and Postcommunion	Communion is the sacrament of ecclesial unity, and the Postcommunion asks cleansing from hidden faults and deliverance from enemy snares. The communicant receives what he must become: a member reconciled in Christ's body.

Thread	Synthesis
Speech and altar	Peter's warning about the tongue explains Matthew's altar scene. The Church teaches that words can profane worship before the gift ever reaches the altar.
Injury and blessing	Patristic exegesis does not deny real wrongs; it forbids revenge as the soul's organizing principle. Blessing breaks the cycle of retaliation.
Fear and charity	Fear of God exposes the seriousness of contempt; charity seeks the brother. Together they make reconciliation more than social politeness.
Sacrifice, communion, cleansing	The Mass's own movement enacts the teaching: the offering must pass through reconciliation so Communion may be truthful and hidden faults may be cleansed.
Church's instruction	The faithful are being told: do not use worship to bypass the brother. Guard the tongue, seek peace quickly, and let the altar judge anger before anger corrupts the gift.

Exegetical Notes

- Matthew 5 moves from the external act of murder to anger, contempt, and unreconciled memory.
- Christ says, "if thy brother hath anything against thee." The initiative belongs to the worshipper even when pride prefers delay.
- The altar image gives urgency: even a sacred act pauses before the demand of charity.

Witness	Short text	Homiletic use
St. John Chrysostom	Be reconciled so the work may not remain imperfect.	Use this to show that unreconciled worship is unfinished worship.
St. Gregory the Great	Strife throws away what should aid remission.	This gives a sharp warning without weakening the mercy of confession.
St. Jerome	The text says the brother has something against you.	Preach initiative: do not wait for the other person to make peace easy.

Witness	Short text	Homiletic use
St. Cyprian	Unity belongs to the sacrifice of the Church.	Connect private resentment to ecclesial communion.

Thread	Synthesis
Altar and brother	This Sunday makes reconciliation liturgical. The movement is not from worship to ethics as an afterthought; ethics is demanded by the altar.
Interior and communal peace	The Epistle's humility and the Gospel's reconciliation reveal that peace starts in the sanctified heart and becomes ecclesial communion.
Justice and mercy	Christ does not abolish justice; he deepens it from external nonviolence to purified memory, speech, and intention.
One desire	The Communion's <i>Unam petii</i> gathers the scattered soul. The person who wants one thing can surrender the many claims of resentment.
Prayer focus	Before offering prayer, name one relationship needing repair and take the first truthful step toward peace.

Preaching Applications

- Distinguish reconciliation from pretending no wrong occurred; truth and charity must meet.
- Ask hearers to examine contemptuous speech, not only obvious anger.
- Recommend a concrete step: apology, restitution, intercessory prayer, or counsel where direct contact would be imprudent.

Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, *Dominica Quinta post Pentecosten*.
- Suggested patristic study: Chrysostom on Matthew 5; Cyprian, On the Unity of the Catholic Church; Augustine on Psalm 26.

Full Patristic and Sainly Texts

- St. John Chrysostom, in the *Catena Aurea* on Matthew 5: "If love alone is not enough to induce us to be reconciled to our neighbour, the desire that our work should not remain imperfect, and especially in the holy place, should induce us."
- St. Gregory the Great, in the *Catena Aurea* on Matthew 5: "He is not willing to accept sacrifice at the hands of those who are at variance."
- St. Jerome, in the *Catena Aurea* on Matthew 5: "It is not, If thou hast ought against thy brother; but, If thy brother has ought against thee."